

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 2-3 · with clues

Name _____

Date _____

Use the clues. Change **one letter** each step to make the word that matches the clue.

Ladder 1

N O T E

Start here

1

You smell with it

2

A flower with thorns on its stem

3

To go up, like the sun in the morning

4

To sit on a bike or horse and go

S I D E

Finish here

Ladder 2

B A L L

Start here

1

It rings: ding-dong!

2

The opposite of buy

3

A sea animal with flippers and whiskers

4

To get better after a cut or scrape

H E A R

Finish here

Ladder 3

P I C K

Start here

1

Mix red and white paint to get this

2

Where you wash your hands

3

To make music with your voice

4

A bird uses it to fly

W I N D

Finish here

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

N O T E

Start here

1 N O S E

You smell with it

2 R O S E

A flower with thorns on its stem

3 R I S E

To go up, like the sun in the morning

4 R I D E

To sit on a bike or horse and go

S I D E

Finish here

Ladder 2

B A L L

Start here

1 B E L L

It rings: ding-dong!

2 S E L L

The opposite of buy

3 S E A L

A sea animal with flippers and whiskers

4 H E A L

To get better after a cut or scrape

H E A R

Finish here

Ladder 3

P I C K

Start here

1 P I N K

Mix red and white paint to get this

2 S I N K

Where you wash your hands

3 S I N G

To make music with your voice

4 W I N G

A bird uses it to fly

W I N D

Finish here